

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____ / 30

Reading Comprehension Test

The Bark of the Bog Owl

by Jonathan Rogers

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

Section 1: Easy

1. What is Aidan Errolson's usual job at Longleaf Manor?

- A. Tending his father's sheep
- B. Training the king's horses for battle
- C. Guarding the gates of Tambluff Castle
- D. Working with miners beneath Greasy Cave

2. Who is Dobro Turtlebane?

- A. A messenger boy from King Darrow's camp
- B. A young member of the feechiefolk
- C. A Pyrthen soldier who changes sides
- D. One of Aidan's older brothers

3. Who declares that Aidan will become the Wilderking?

- A. Errol, Aidan's father
- B. King Darrow of Corenwald
- C. Bayard the Truthspeaker
- D. Gergo Snagroot, the feechie chief

4. What animal does Aidan help capture as a gift for King Darrow?

- A. A black panther
- B. A wild river horse
- C. A giant catfish
- D. An alligator

5. Which empire tries to take control of Corenwald?

- A. The Pyrthen Empire
- B. The Tambluff Dominion
- C. The Bonifay Kingdom
- D. The Eastern Frontier Alliance

6. What title do the feechiees give Aidan after hearing how he saved Dobro?

- A. Swamp Warden
- B. Feechiefriend
- C. Keeper of the Tam
- D. Champion of the Hummock

7. Who challenges Corenwald to send out a champion?

- A. Lord Radnor
- B. Emperor Mareddud
- C. Greidawl
- D. Chief Gergo

8. What weapon does Aidan choose for his fight with Greidawl?

- A. A long spear from the royal armory
- B. A heavy sword and shield
- C. A pair of feechie hunting knives
- D. His own sling

9. Who helps Aidan explore the caves beneath the Pyrthen camp?

- A. Arliss
- B. Herschel
- C. Jasper
- D. Rabbo

10. What dangerous supply do Aidan and Arliss find underground?

- A. Barrels of poisoned arrows
- B. Barrels of flame powder
- C. Crates of stolen royal armor
- D. Cages holding captured feechie

Section 2: Medium**11. Why does Aidan fight the panther during his first adventure with Dobro?**

- A. He wants to bring its hide to King Darrow as a royal gift.
- B. Bayard has ordered him to prove that the prophecy is true.
- C. He is trying to protect Dobro from being killed.
- D. The animal has scattered his father's sheep across the frontier.

12. Why does Errol distrust the proposed alliance with Pyrth?

- A. He fears the treaty will require Aidan to live in Pyrth as a hostage.
- B. He believes Corenwald should stop trading with every neighboring land.
- C. He wants Lord Radnor to rule Corenwald instead of King Darrow.
- D. He knows Pyrth has attacked Corenwald before and may use peace to gain control.

13. What does the Pyrthen speech at the treaty feast reveal?

- A. Pyrth intends to annex Corenwald and station soldiers there.
- B. Pyrth plans to give Corenwald new land along the Eastern Frontier.
- C. The Pyrthen army has agreed to leave the region forever.
- D. Emperor Mareddud wants Aidan to serve as his personal messenger.

14. Why is Aidan spared at the Meeting Hummock?

- A. Bayard arrives and orders the feechie to release him.
- B. Dobro admits that Aidan saved his life from a panther.
- C. Aidan defeats Chief Gergo in a wrestling match.
- D. The feechie discover that Aidan can imitate a bog owl.

15. What does the scar from Aidan's feechie initiation represent?

- A. His promise to keep the caves beneath Corenwald secret
- B. His victory over every feechie boy at the feast
- C. His acceptance as a friend of the feechiefolk
- D. His appointment as the next chief of the Meeting Hummock

16. Why is Aidan disappointed when he reaches the Corenwelder battle camp?

- A. His brothers have already returned home without telling him.

- B. The king refuses to let anyone from Longleaf enter the camp.
- C. The army has moved so far west that Aidan cannot find it.
- D. The soldiers seem discouraged and unprepared instead of eager to defend Corenwald.

17. Why does Greidawl's repeated challenge weaken the Corenwalders?

- A. Their unanswered fear makes them feel helpless and ashamed.
- B. It prevents supplies from reaching King Darrow's command tent.
- C. It convinces the feechees to support the Pyrthen Empire.
- D. Their strongest soldiers leave to search for Bayard.

18. Why does Aidan reject the heavy armor offered before his duel?

- A. Bayard tells him that all armor is forbidden by the One God.
- B. It hinders him, while his sling fits the skills he actually has.
- C. The armor belongs to Greidawl and may contain a hidden curse.
- D. King Darrow needs every suit of armor for his royal guards.

19. How does Aidan's victory over Greidawl change the Corenwald army?

- A. It persuades the soldiers that the war is over and they can go home.
- B. It makes the army depend entirely on Aidan for every decision.
- C. It restores their courage and reminds them who they are.
- D. It causes them to replace King Darrow with Bayard immediately.

20. Why does Aidan join the miner-scouts after the Pyrthens use their thunder-tubes?

- A. He wants to escape the battlefield and return to the feechees.
- B. He believes the miners know where Bayard has hidden Samson.
- C. He hopes to find treasure that can pay for a larger army.
- D. His small size and courage may help them find a route under the enemy camp.

21. What does Gustus's trust in Arliss's 'miner's head' show?

- A. Good leaders recognize useful gifts even in younger teammates.
- B. A leader should always follow the youngest person without question.
- C. Maps and careful preparation are useless in dangerous places.
- D. Physical strength matters more than knowledge or experience.

22. Why do Aidan and Arliss continue when Gustus wants to turn back?

- A. They are lost and mistakenly believe the miners have abandoned them.
- B. They believe they are close to the enemy camp and can still help Corenwald.
- C. They want to prove they can survive underground without any adults.
- D. They have promised Dobro that they will search for a hidden feechee village.

23. How do Aidan and Arliss turn the Pyrthens' strength against them?

- A. They capture Greidawl's horse and ride it through the Pyrthen lines.
- B. They redirect the underground lake to flood the entire enemy camp.
- C. They ignite the enemy's stored flame powder and destroy its supply.
- D. They convince the Pyrthen guards that Bayard commands their army.

24. What does Dobro's friendship contribute most to Aidan's growth?

- A. It teaches him that civilized people should avoid the wilderness.
- B. It gives him a way to escape every duty at Longleaf Manor.
- C. It proves that prophecy matters more than personal choices.
- D. It helps him value people unlike himself and become comfortable in wild places.

25. Why is the command 'Remember!' important after Greidawl falls?

- A. Aidan wants Corenwalders to recall their faith, courage, and heritage.
- B. Aidan is warning his brothers not to forget the route back to Longleaf.
- C. King Darrow has forgotten the terms of Greidawl's challenge.
- D. The Pyrthens must remember where they stored the flame powder.

Section 3: Hard

26. What best explains the difference between Aidan's early dreams of heroism and his later actions?

- A. He learns that heroes should seek excitement even when no one needs help.
- B. He learns that courage means serving others faithfully despite fear and uncertainty.
- C. He decides that winning praise from King Darrow is the highest form of bravery.
- D. He discovers that prophecy removes the need to prepare or make wise choices.

27. How does the book use the contrast between 'wild' and 'civilized' people?

- A. To show that wild people are always good and civilized people are always corrupt
- B. To prove that Corenwald can survive only by abandoning towns and farms
- C. To suggest that a healthy kingdom needs both order and untamed courage
- D. To argue that feechees and civilizers can never understand one another

28. Which statement best expresses the book's view of faith and action?

- A. Faith guarantees that faithful people will never feel frightened or confused.
- B. Faith matters only to prophets, while warriors must rely on their own strength.
- C. Faith means waiting for a miracle instead of using the abilities one has been given.
- D. Faith gives Aidan courage to act, but he still must choose, prepare, and take risks.

29. Why is Aidan a fitting choice for the Wilderking even though he is young?

- A. He combines humility, loyalty, courage, and an ability to unite different people.
- B. He is the only Errolson who wants power more than service or friendship.
- C. He defeats every opponent through greater size and formal military training.
- D. He obeys every leader without questioning fear, surrender, or injustice.

30. What larger purpose does Aidan's friendship with Dobro serve in the story?

- A. It provides comic relief but has little connection to Aidan's future leadership.
- B. It foreshadows a Wilderking who can bring Corenwald's divided peoples together.
- C. It shows that Aidan must leave his family and become a feechee permanently.
- D. It proves that the feechees secretly planned the Pyrthen invasion from the beginning.